

ISLAM MAHROUS

Multi-Brand Hospitality Operator | Portfolio Growth & Asset Transformation | GCC, EMEA & International

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

International hospitality executive with 30+ years of multi-property leadership across the GCC, North Africa, the Levant, and broader EMEA. Extensive operating experience with Marriott International, IHG, Starwood, Accor, and independent luxury brands, spanning Saudi Arabia, UAE, Egypt, Libya, and The Gambia.

Currently Group Operations Director at Prime Hotels Group, Riyadh, directing a multi-brand Saudi portfolio scaling toward 10,000 rooms by 2030. Previously appointed by Marriott International as sole General Manager mandated to lead operational excellence across the Egypt portfolio of 19 properties and 3,000+ rooms. Independent consulting practice advises owners across pre-opening, turnaround, and brand conversion mandates. Marriott Middle East & Africa GM Award for Customer Excellence. Six Sigma Black Belt. MBA, GPA 3.56.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Portfolio & Asset Management	Multi-property operations governance • Owner and investor advisory • Asset performance optimization • Capital project oversight
Operational Excellence & Quality	Brand conversion (Marriott, IHG, Starwood, Accor) • International quality audit readiness • Six Sigma Black Belt • SOP design and deployment
Revenue & Profit Optimisation	Full P&L ownership • RevPAR, ADR, GOP, EBITDA growth • Cost restructuring • STR benchmarking and competitive set analysis
Development & Pre-Opening	International new-build commissioning • Vendor and FF&E procurement • Marriott Technical Services • Soft and grand opening delivery
Stakeholder & Owner Relations	Ownership and board advisory • International brand corporate liaison • Multi-market regulatory navigation • Cross-cultural team leadership

SELECTED CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **19 Marriott Egypt Properties | 3,000+ Rooms | Portfolio Operational Excellence Lead** (sole GM appointed by Marriott International; +10% guest satisfaction, +8% F&B revenue, +3% RevPAR portfolio-wide).
- **5 Pre-Opening Mandates | 1,700+ Rooms | 3 Countries** (Saudi Arabia, Libya, Egypt) — luxury, upscale full-service, dual-brand cluster, and new-build formats delivered at 90 to 95% operational readiness.
- **\$10M+ Capital Renovation Portfolio | Live-Operations Delivery** across multi-brand Marriott and IHG flagship assets in Saudi Arabia and Egypt, with 7 to 20% cost optimisation.
- **International Consulting Practice | 3 Owner-Side Mandates** across brand conversion (IHG), turnaround (\$3.5M, +18% occupancy / +20% F&B), and luxury pre-opening (90% occupancy in 4 months).
- **+25% RevPAR | +30% Guest Satisfaction | Sheraton Montazah Hotel** (288 rooms, 9-year tenure with comprehensive renovation of 40-year-old Marriott asset).
- **6 Countries | 7 International Brands | 30+ Years** (Saudi Arabia, UAE, Egypt, Libya, The Gambia, Switzerland) across Marriott, Sheraton, IHG, Starwood, Accor, Sofitel, and independent luxury.

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Prime Hotels Group Riyadh, Saudi Arabia <i>Group Operations Director Multi-Brand Saudi Portfolio (Luxury, Midscale, Serviced Apartments)</i>	Dec 2025 to Present
▪ Full P&L accountability and operational governance directed across multi-brand Saudi portfolio (luxury, midscale, serviced apartments), reporting to ownership and board. ▪ Monthly P&L review cadence and STR benchmarking dashboards established across the portfolio in the first quarter, surfacing cost optimisation opportunities and improving reporting transparency for ownership and board. ▪ Operational governance framework architected for portfolio expansion to 10,000 rooms by 2030, with scalable SOPs, GM performance management structures, and KPIs aligned to Vision 2030 and international tourism growth mandates. ▪ Asset performance aligned with investment objectives through competitive set analysis and portfolio-wide accountability frameworks established with owners and General Managers. ▪ Pre-opening and seasonal demand playbooks developed to optimise performance across peak periods, supporting the group's expansion pipeline.	
Four Points by Sheraton, King Abdulaziz Road Riyadh, KSA <i>Owner's Representative, Pre-Opening 172 Rooms, Marriott New-Build</i>	Apr 2023 to Jul 2025
▪ Full development and pre-opening cycle managed on behalf of ownership for 172-room Marriott new-build; brand compliance, timeline adherence, and capital budget discipline maintained across multi-year program . ▪ -12% pre-opening budget reduction achieved through vendor and procurement negotiation, while maintaining full Marriott FF&E specifications. ▪ 150+ pre-opening staff recruited and onboarded; critical technical and design issues resolved, delivering on schedule and within capital budget.	

Sheraton Montazah Hotel, Marriott International | Alexandria, Egypt**Jun 2014 to Mar 2023***General Manager (Jan 2021 to Mar 2023) | Hotel Manager in Charge (Jul 2015 to Dec 2020) | Deputy GM (Jun 2014 to Jun 2015) | 288 Rooms*

- **+25% RevPAR growth and +30% guest-satisfaction uplift** delivered across a **9-year tenure** with **full P&L accountability**, culminating in the most comprehensive renovation in the hotel's 40-year history.
- **-15% energy costs and -20% maintenance spend** achieved through full infrastructure modernization (boilers, transformers, generators, chillers, fire and life safety, complete kitchen renovation) in collaboration with **Marriott Design and Technical Services**.
- **Marriott Egypt competitive set outperformed** across multiple market cycles through **STR benchmarking** and data-driven performance dashboards.

Marriott Egypt General Managers Council | Egypt Region**2018 to 2022***GM in Charge of Operational Excellence | 19 Properties, 3,000+ Rooms*

- **Sole GM appointed by Marriott International** to lead **operational excellence** across the entire Egypt portfolio (**19 properties, 3,000+ rooms**); appointment validated by 9-year flagship tenure at Sheraton Montazah.
- **+10% aggregate guest satisfaction and +8% F&B revenue** delivered within 18 months through **portfolio-wide standardized service protocols** and SOP rollout.
- **+3% average RevPAR increase** across all **19 properties** driven through cross-property best-practice sharing and strategic alignment with Egypt General Managers.
- **Quarterly performance reviews and strategic planning sessions** facilitated portfolio-wide, ensuring alignment with **Marriott International standards** across diverse property types.

Sheraton Miramar Resort | El Gouna, Hurghada, Egypt**Jul 2011 to Jun 2014***Deputy General Manager in Charge | 339 Rooms*

- **+12% guest-satisfaction improvement and post-renovation revenue growth** delivered through **\$5M phased refurbishment** executed with full operational continuity and strategic repositioning.
- **+15% ADR and +8% occupancy gain** in year one post-renovation, alongside **-7% payroll expenses** through cross-training and scheduling optimization.

Four Points & Sheraton Tripoli | Tripoli, Libya**Dec 2009 to Jun 2011***Cluster Executive Assistant Manager, Pre-Opening | 718 Rooms, Dual-Brand Cluster*

- **95% operational readiness** achieved across **718-room dual-brand cluster pre-opening** in North Africa under challenging political conditions, with systems established to **Starwood international brand standards**.

Sheraton Miramar Resort | El Gouna, Hurghada, Egypt**Jun 2003 to Nov 2009***Director of Operational Innovation (2005 to 2009) | Deputy Director of Guest Services & Six Sigma Green Belt (2003 to 2004)*

- **4 certified Best Practices exported to Marriott's Europe, Africa & Middle East Division** as **first Director of Operational Innovation** in the AFIO region; **Best Director of Operational Innovation, AFIO Region (2007)**.
- **Operational Innovation Coach** appointment across **5 properties** in Egypt and Morocco, leading divisional projects to lift guest satisfaction, employee satisfaction, and revenues.
- **4 Six Sigma DMAIC projects** executed at Sheraton Miramar (2004 to 2006), **exceeding all financial budgets** and Six Sigma criteria matrices; projects spanned guest satisfaction, service-culture SOPs, tour-operator revenue optimisation, and employee engagement.
- **Best EBITDA Margin Growth, Marriott EMEA Division** awarded to management team (2003); transferred from **Sheraton Soma Bay** as Six Sigma Green Belt due to outstanding performance.

Task Force Pre-Opening EAM Mandates | Le Meridien Makkah Towers, KSA (1,323 rooms, 2008) and Sheraton Gambia (181 rooms, 2008): 3-month international specialist mandates providing pre-opening EAM expertise for large-scale openings across the Middle East and West Africa.

Early Career (1993 to 2004) | Progressive advancement from Front Office Agent to Assistant Director of Front Office across international brands in UAE (Dubai) and Egypt. Pre-opening contribution at City Centre Sofitel Dubai (1998). Best Trainer Award, Hurghada InterContinental Resort & Casino (2000). Six Sigma Green Belt prior to Black Belt certification.

INDEPENDENT CONSULTING & ADVISORY ENGAGEMENTS**Crowne Plaza Mirage by IHG | Alexandria, Egypt****Aug to Dec 2025***Independent Brand Conversion Consultant | 96 Rooms*

- **Engaged by ownership to deliver full IHG Crowne Plaza brand conversion** within 4 months from a **zero brand baseline**, transitioning a 96-room independent property to fully compliant IHG standards.
- **Opera Cloud PMS, Concerto revenue management, and IHG guest-recognition systems** deployed across all departments; full staff-retraining curriculum designed and delivered to IHG service-culture, quality-audit, and guest-experience standards.
- **Brand-audit readiness achieved on schedule** with **zero guest-facing disruption**; ownership advised on franchise compliance, asset optimisation, and post-conversion strategy as **principal liaison with IHG corporate**.

Porto Said Resort | Port Said, Egypt**Apr to Aug 2024***Independent Turnaround & Renovation Consultant | 168 Rooms, 24-Outlet Retail Mall*

- **Engaged by ownership to deliver turnaround and renovation consultancy** across 168-room property and 24-outlet retail mall; **+18% occupancy growth, +20% F&B revenue, and return to positive GOP within 4 months** outperforming Egyptian renovation ROI benchmarks by 10 points, ahead of ownership's breakeven plan.
- **+15% operational efficiency and +30% guest satisfaction** achieved through restructuring of **200+ person operating team** and targeted performance management; property repositioned within the Port S'aid competitive set.

The V Luxury Resort Sahl Hasheesh | Hurghada, Egypt**May 2023 to Mar 2024***Independent Pre-Opening Consultant | 298 Rooms, Luxury Segment*

- **Engaged by ownership to deliver full pre-opening consultancy** for 298-room luxury resort, providing **end-to-end advisory** across staffing strategy, **PMS implementation**, brand standards deployment, and **commercial launch planning**.
- **90% occupancy within 4 months of launch** achieved through **competitive positioning strategy** designed for the **Red Sea luxury corridor**, outperforming the 12 to 18 month industry standard for luxury-segment stabilisation.
- **+12% guest satisfaction in opening quarter** delivered through bespoke service-culture programme and custom training curriculum built for **300+ pre-opening team members**; ownership advised on opening-day operations and post-launch optimisation.

STRATEGIC PROJECTS & TRANSFORMATIONS

Property	Brand	Scale	Mandate & Outcome
Sheraton Montazah Hotel	Marriott	288 rooms	Renovation + GM tenure: +25% RevPAR, +30% guest satisfaction, -15% energy / -20% maintenance costs
Marriott Egypt Portfolio	Marriott	19 properties / 3,000+ rooms	Operational Excellence lead: +10% guest satisfaction, +8% F&B, +3% RevPAR portfolio-wide
Four Points by Sheraton, Riyadh	Marriott	172 rooms	Owner's Rep, new-build pre-opening: -12% pre-opening budget, on-schedule delivery
Crowne Plaza Mirage	IHG	96 rooms	Brand-conversion consultancy: full IHG compliance in 4 months from zero baseline
Porto Said Resort	Independent	168 rooms + 24-outlet mall	Turnaround consultancy: \$3.5M renovation, +18% occupancy, +20% F&B, GOP positive in 4 months
The V Luxury Resort Sahl Hasheesh	Independent Luxury	298 rooms	Pre-opening consultancy: 90% occupancy in 4 months, +12% guest satisfaction
Four Points & Sheraton Tripoli	Starwood	718 rooms (cluster)	Dual-brand cluster pre-opening: 95% operational readiness in challenging conditions
Sheraton Miramar, El Gouna	Marriott	339 rooms	Renovation + Deputy GM: \$5M refurbishment, +15% ADR, +8% occupancy, -7% payroll
Task Force Pre-Opening Mandates	Marriott	1,500+ rooms	Le Meridien Makkah Towers (1,323 rooms) + Sheraton Gambia (181 rooms): 3-month specialist EAM mandates

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- **2017: Marriott Middle East & Africa General Manager Award for Customer Excellence.**
- **2017: Best-in-Class Star Voice Award, 2nd consecutive year**, recognising outstanding hospitality achievement.
- **2007: Best Director of Operational Innovation**, Africa & Indian Ocean (AFIO) Region, **Marriott International**.
- **2006:** Selected to lead **Marriott divisional initiatives** across guest, employee, and revenue performance; **4 Best Practices exported to Marriott EMEA Division**.
- **2005:** Appointed **Director of Operational Innovation, Sheraton Miramar; Operational Innovation Coach for 5 properties** across Egypt and Morocco.
- **2004 to 2006: Led Six Sigma efforts** at Sheraton Miramar, **exceeding all financial budgets** and Six Sigma criteria matrices.
- **2003:** Member of Sheraton Miramar team awarded **Best EBITDA Margin Growth, Marriott EMEA Division**; transferred from Sheraton Soma Bay as **Six Sigma Green Belt** for outstanding performance.

EDUCATION, PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & LANGUAGES

- **Academic Qualifications:** MBA, Strategic Management & Hospitality Leadership | **Arab Academy for Science and Technology University, Egypt** | GPA 3.56 / 4.0 (Excellent)
- **BSc, Tourism & Hotels** | **Alexandria University, Egypt** •
- **Rooms Division Diploma** | **Glion Institute of Higher Education, Switzerland**

Professional Certifications: Six Sigma Black Belt (DMAIC, D1/D2/D3; 4 EMEA implementation projects)

- **Operational Innovation Director & Coach Certification**, Marriott International
- **Yield Management Certification** • **Emotional Intelligence Leadership Training** • **CTC Craft Training Certificate (Train the Trainer)**

Languages: Arabic (Native Proficiency) • English (Fluent, Business Level) • German (Intermediate)